

FLIGHT

1. Passage anchor

> “...helped carry Kelvin’s father down seventeen **flights of stairs** because the lift was still out of order.”

Passage meaning

flight of stairs = a continuous set of stairs between one floor/landing and the next

一段樓梯；一層樓梯

Here, Kelvin’s father had to be carried down **seventeen separate stretches of stairs** because the lift was not working.

Practice

1. We climbed three **flights of stairs**.

我們爬了三**層樓梯**。

2. Her apartment is five **flights up**.

她的單位要走上五**層樓梯**。

Core meanings of FLIGHT

2. flight — journey by aircraft

= journey made in an aircraft

航班；飛行旅程

Examples

1. Our **flight** leaves at eight.

我們的**航班**八點起飛。

2. The **flight** from London to Hong Kong takes many hours.

從倫敦到香港的**航程**需要很多小時。

This is probably the most familiar everyday sense.

3. flight — scheduled aircraft service

= particular airplane service operating at a specific time and route

****航班****

Examples

1. My ****flight**** was delayed.

我的****航班****延誤了。

2. Which ****flight**** are you on?

你搭哪一班****航班****？

Act of flying

4. flight — the act or ability of flying

= movement through the air, especially by a bird, aircraft, insect, etc.

****飛行；飛翔****

Examples

1. The bird took ****flight****.

那隻鳥展翅****飛走了****。

2. Scientists studied the ****flight**** of insects.

科學家研究昆蟲的****飛行****。

This is the broader physical sense behind aircraft travel.

5. in flight

= while flying

****在飛行中；飛行時****

Examples

1. The bird changed direction ****in flight****.

那隻鳥在****飛行中****改變了方向。

2. The aircraft was refueled ****in flight****.

飛機在****飛行中****接受空中加油。

Stairs

6. flight of stairs

= continuous series of steps between two landings or floors

****一段樓梯；一層樓梯****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. We walked up a ****flight of stairs****.

我們走上了一****段樓梯****。

2. The office is two ****flights up****.

辦公室要走上兩****層樓梯****。

7. flight — staircase section

= one continuous section of a staircase

****一段樓梯****

Examples

1. There is another ****flight**** after the landing.

平台之後還有另一****段樓梯****。

2. The building has several short ****flights**** connected by landings.

大樓有幾****段短樓梯****，中間由平台連接。

Escape / fleeing

8. flight — escape from danger

= act of running away or escaping from danger, threat, conflict, etc.

****逃跑；逃亡；逃離****

Examples

1. Thousands were forced into ****flight**** by the fighting.

戰鬥迫使數千人****逃亡****。

2. His sudden **flight** raised suspicion.

他突然**逃走**引起了懷疑。

Formal compared with ordinary **escape** or **run away**.

9. take flight — flee

= run away, escape, or suddenly leave

逃走；**逃離**

Examples

1. The suspects **took flight** when the police arrived.

警方到場時，嫌疑人**逃走了**。

2. The animals **took flight** at the sound.

動物聽到聲響後**四散逃走 / 飛走**。

Depending on the subject, this can be literal flying or figurative fleeing.

10. put someone to flight

Formal/literary:

= cause someone to flee

使某人逃走；**擊退**

Examples

1. The defenders **put the attackers to flight**.

守軍把進攻者**擊退**。

2. The sudden noise **put the animals to flight**.

突然的聲響把動物**嚇跑了**。

Flight response

11. fight-or-flight response

= automatic physiological response preparing the body either to confront danger or escape from it
戰鬥或逃跑反應；戰或逃反應

Examples

1. Stress can trigger the **fight-or-flight response**.
壓力可以觸發**戰或逃反應**。
2. The body releases hormones during a **fight-or-flight response**.
身體在**戰鬥或逃跑反應**期間會釋放荷爾蒙。

Here **flight** means **escape**.

Movement/path through the air

12. flight — path through the air

= movement or trajectory of an object through the air
飛行路徑；飛行軌跡

Examples

1. The camera followed the **flight of the ball**.
攝影機追蹤球的**飛行軌跡**。
2. Wind affected the arrow's **flight**.
風影響了箭的**飛行路徑**。

13. flight of a ball / projectile

= way a ball, arrow, projectile, etc. moves through the air
球 / 投射物的飛行軌跡

Examples

1. The spin changed the **flight of the ball**.
旋轉改變了球的**飛行軌跡**。
2. The arrow maintained a straight **flight**.
那支箭保持較直的**飛行路徑**。

Useful in sport and physics contexts.

Flight path

14. flight path

= route or trajectory followed by an aircraft, bird, projectile, etc. through the air

****飛行路線；飛行軌跡****

Examples

1. The aircraft changed its ****flight path****.
飛機改變了****飛行路線****。
2. The building lies under a major ****flight path****.
那棟大樓位於主要****航道****下方。

Aviation compounds

15. flight time

= amount of time spent flying

****飛行時間；航程時間****

Examples

1. The ****flight time**** is about twelve hours.
****飛行時間****約十二小時。
2. Strong winds increased the ****flight time****.
強風增加了****飛行時間****。

16. flight attendant

= person who looks after passengers and safety aboard an aircraft

****空中服務員；空服員****

Examples

1. A ****flight attendant**** showed us our seats.
一名****空服員****帶我們到座位。

2. The **flight attendants** prepared the cabin for landing.

空中服務員為降落作準備。

17. flight crew

= crew responsible for operating and serving aboard an aircraft

機組人員；飛行機組

Examples

1. The **flight crew** completed the safety checks.

機組人員完成了安全檢查。

2. The captain briefed the **flight crew**.

機長向**飛行機組**作簡報。

18. flight deck

= cockpit or area from which an aircraft is controlled; on some ships, deck used for aircraft operations

駕駛艙；飛行甲板

Examples

1. Only authorized personnel may enter the **flight deck**.

只有獲授權人員可以進入**駕駛艙**。

2. Aircraft were moved across the carrier's **flight deck**.

飛機在航空母艦的**飛行甲板**上移動。

19. flight recorder

= device recording aircraft data and/or cockpit audio

飛行記錄器；黑盒

Examples

1. Investigators recovered the **flight recorder**.

調查人員找到了**飛行記錄器**。

2. Data from the **flight recorder** was examined.

調查人員檢查了**黑盒**內的數據。

Flight risk

20. flight risk

= person considered likely to run away, especially to avoid trial, prosecution, debt, responsibility, etc.

有潛逃風險的人；潛逃風險

Examples

1. The court considered him a **flight risk**.

法院認為他有**潛逃風險**。

2. Bail was refused because of the **flight risk**.

因為有**潛逃風險**，保釋被拒。

This develops directly from **flight = escape**.

Imagination / thought

21. flight of fancy

= imaginative idea that is unrealistic, fanciful, or unlikely to happen

幻想；不切實際的想像

Examples

1. The plan sounded like a **flight of fancy**.

那個計畫聽起來像是**不切實際的幻想**。

2. At first, the idea seemed merely a **flight of fancy**.

起初，這個想法似乎只是一場**幻想**。

High-value idiom.

22. flight of imagination

= imaginative mental excursion or creative act

****想像的馳騁；豐富想像****

Examples

1. The novel is a remarkable ****flight of imagination****.

這本小說展現了非凡的****想像力馳騁****。

2. The design began as a ****flight of imagination****.

這個設計最初源於一次****大膽想像****。

Tasting flight

23. flight — selection of small samples

Especially food/drink service:

= set of several small samples served together for comparison

****試飲 / 試食組合；品鑑組****

Examples

1. We ordered a coffee ****flight****.

我們點了一組咖啡****品鑑組合****。

2. The restaurant serves a dessert ****flight****.

這家餐廳供應一套甜點****試食組合****。

Modern and increasingly common.

24. beer / wine / coffee flight

= several small servings offered together so customers can compare varieties

****啤酒 / 葡萄酒 / 咖啡試飲組合****

Examples

1. The café offers a cold-brew ****flight****.

咖啡店提供冷萃咖啡****試飲組合****。

2. They sampled a ****flight of wines****.

他們品嚐了一套葡萄酒**試飲組合**。

Group of birds / aircraft

25. flight — group moving/flying together

= group of birds, aircraft, etc. flying together

一群飛行中的鳥 / 飛機；飛行編隊

Examples

1. A **flight of birds** crossed the sky.

一群**飛鳥**掠過天空。

2. A **flight of aircraft** approached the area.

一個飛機**編隊**接近該區域。

Lower priority than the main senses, but established.

Military aviation

26. flight — small aircraft unit

= small unit of aircraft and personnel, especially in military aviation

飛行小隊；飛行分隊

Examples

1. The squadron was divided into several **flights**.

中隊分成幾個**飛行分隊**。

2. He commanded a **flight** of aircraft.

他指揮一個飛機**小隊**。

Specialist but established.

Sports / competition grouping

27. flight — division or group in competition

In some sports/tournaments:

= group or category of competitors arranged by level, score, age, etc.

****組別；級別****

Examples

1. Players were divided into separate ****flights****.
選手被分成不同****組別****。
2. She won the second ****flight**** of the competition.
她贏得該比賽第二****組別****的冠軍。

Established but domain-specific.

Musical / literary rising sequence

28. flight — rapid sequence or passage

Literary/music:

= rapid, elaborate, or soaring sequence of notes, words, ideas, etc.

****一連串快速 / 華麗的音符或表達****

Examples

1. The violinist played a brilliant ****flight of notes****.
小提琴手奏出一連串華麗快速的****音符****。
2. The speech contained several rhetorical ****flights****.
演說中有幾段華麗奔放的****修辭****。

Lower-priority literary sense.

FLIGHTY

29. flighty

= easily distracted, changeable, unreliable, or not very serious

****輕浮的；善變的；不穩重的****

Examples

1. He seemed rather **flighty** when he was younger.
他年輕時似乎相當**不穩重**。

2. She is sometimes unfairly described as **flighty**.
她有時被不公平地形容為**輕浮善變**。

Historically related to rapid movement/flight, but now a distinct adjective.

FLIGHTLESS

30. flightless

= unable to fly

不會飛的；無飛行能力的

Examples

1. Penguins are **flightless birds**.
企鵝是**不會飛的鳥**。

2. Some island birds became **flightless** over time.
有些島嶼鳥類後來演化成**不具飛行能力**。

Useful family form.

IN-FLIGHT

31. in-flight

= occurring, provided, or used during a flight

飛行中的；機上提供的

Examples

1. The airline provides **in-flight entertainment**.
航空公司提供**機上娛樂**。

2. We ordered an **in-flight meal**.
我們點了**機上餐**。

Key contrasts

32. flight vs fly

****fly****

= verb: move through the air

****飛 ; 飛行****

****flight****

= noun: the act/journey/path of flying

****飛行 ; 航班 ; 飛行路徑****

Compare:

> Birds fly south.

> 鳥兒向南飛。

> the birds' flight south

> 鳥兒向南的飛行

33. flight vs trip

****trip****

= journey or visit, by any mode of transport

****旅程 ; 出行****

****flight****

= specifically journey by aircraft

****航班 ; 航空旅程****

Compare:

> business trip

> 商務旅行

> return flight

> 回程航班

34. flight vs voyage

****voyage****

= long journey, traditionally by sea and sometimes space

****航海；長途航行****

****flight****

= journey through the air

****飛行；航班****

35. flight vs escape

****escape****

= general act of getting away from confinement, danger, etc.

****逃脫；逃走****

****flight****

= more formal/literary noun emphasizing fleeing from danger

****逃亡；逃離****

Compare:

> escape from prison

> 越獄逃脫

> flight from war

> 逃離戰爭

36. flight vs staircase

****staircase****

= entire structure containing stairs, often including several flights and landings

****樓梯；樓梯間****

****flight of stairs****

= one continuous section of steps between landings

****一段樓梯****

So:

> a staircase may contain several flights.

37. flight vs floor / storey

This distinction is crucial in the passage.

****flight****

= section of stairs

****一段樓梯****

****floor / storey****

= level of a building

****樓層****

One floor can correspond roughly to one flight in some buildings, but ****not always****.

Therefore:

> seventeen flights of stairs

means:

****十七段樓梯****

It does not technically guarantee exactly seventeen storeys.

38. flight vs route — aviation

****route****

= planned course between places

****路線****

****flight****

= actual/scheduled aircraft journey

****航班****

Compare:

> airline route between Hong Kong and Tokyo

> 香港至東京的航空路線

> Flight 123

> 123號航班

Meaning map

The central concept of **flight** is:

movement away or through space

From this develop two especially important historical branches.

A. Flying

Aircraft

flight to Tokyo

→ **飛往東京的航班**

Physical flying

bird in flight

→ **飛行中的鳥**

Trajectory

flight of the ball

→ **球的飛行軌跡**

Aviation

flight path

→ **飛行路線**

B. Moving away / escape

Danger

flight from danger

→ **逃離危險**

Legal

flight risk

→ **潛逃風險**

Response

fight-or-flight

→ **戰或逃反應**

There is also an independent everyday architectural sense:

Passage

flight of stairs

→ **一段樓梯**

And several lexicalized extensions:

Imagination

flight of fancy

→ **不切實際的幻想**

Food/drink

tasting flight

→ **試飲 / 試食組合**

Competition

competition flight

→ **比賽組別**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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flight — aircraft journey	乘飛機進行的一段旅程 / 航班
flight — scheduled service	按特定時間與航線運行的一班飛機；航班
flight — act of flying	鳥、飛機等在空中飛行 / 飛翔
in flight	正在飛行中
flight of stairs	兩個平台 / 樓層之間一段連續的樓梯
flight — staircase section	樓梯的一段連續梯級
flight — escape	正式：從危險、衝突等逃走 / 逃亡
take flight — fly	起飛 / 飛走
take flight — escape	突然逃走 / 逃離
put someone to flight	迫使某人逃走 / 把對方擊退
fight-or-flight response	面對危險時身體準備戰鬥或逃跑的反應
flight — trajectory	球、箭等物體在空中的飛行路徑 / 軌跡

flight path	飛機、鳥、投射物等通過空中的飛行路線	
flight time	飛機在空中飛行所需 / 累積的時間	
flight attendant	在飛機上服務乘客及協助安全工作的空服員	
flight crew	負責飛行及機上運作的機組人員	
flight deck	飛機駕駛艙；航空母艦等的飛行甲板	
flight recorder	記錄飛行資料 / 駕駛艙音訊的飛行記錄器	
flight risk	被認為很可能逃走以避開審訊等的人 / 潛逃風險	
flight of fancy	不切實際、富想像力的幻想	
flight of imagination	想像力的自由馳騁 / 大膽想像	
flight — tasting set	一組供比較的小份試飲 / 試食樣品	
flight of birds/aircraft	一群一起飛行的鳥 / 飛行編隊	
flight — military aviation	軍事航空中的飛行小隊 / 分隊	
flight — competition division	某些比賽按水平等劃分的組別 / 級別	
flighty	容易分心、善變或不夠穩重的	
flightless	無法飛行的	
in-flight	飛行期間發生 / 提供的；機上的	

Passage recap

> “...helped carry Kelvin’s father down seventeen **flights of stairs** because the lift was still out of order.”

Here:

flight = **one continuous section of stairs between two landings**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **一段樓梯**

* contextually often **一層樓梯**

Natural contextual translation:

由於升降機仍然故障，他還幫忙把 Kelvin 的父親沿著十七段樓梯抬下去。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

flight in **flight of stairs**

= **a continuous series of steps between two landings**

一段樓梯

The most important learner split is dramatic:

> **a flight to London**
> → 飛往倫敦的**航班**

but:

> **a flight of stairs**
> → **一段樓梯**

and:

> **flight from danger**
> → **逃離 / 逃亡**

> **flight of the ball**
> → 球的**飛行軌跡**

> **flight risk**
> → **潛逃風險**

> **flight of fancy**
> → **不切實際的幻想**

> **coffee flight**
> → **咖啡試飲組合**

One especially important precision point for this passage:

> **seventeen flights of stairs**
> does not strictly mean
> **seventeen floors**

because **flight** counts continuous sections of stairs, while **floor/storey** counts building levels.

So the passage uses the **architectural staircase-section** sense, completely separate from the much more familiar aviation meaning.